Zero Trust Quick Reference: Federal Civilian

Public edition v2.7, 17 October 2026. Public sources only. Ken Connell.

The chain

EO 14028 (May 2021), Section 3: move to Zero Trust Architecture; every agency plans it.

OMB M-22-09 (January 2022): the federal Zero Trust strategy. Specific goals for every agency, due by the end of FY2024, organized by the five CISA pillars.

CISA ZTMM 2.0 (April 2023): how progress is measured. 5 pillars + 3 cross-cutting capabilities; 4 stages: Traditional, Initial, Advanced, Optimal.

OMB M-26-14 (May 2026): federal logging and network visibility. Rescinded M-21-31; aligns logging with the ZTMM.

Zero Trust in one breath

Executive Order 14028 moved the federal government toward Zero Trust in 2021. OMB M-22-09 set goals for every agency across the five CISA pillars: enterprise identities with phishing-resistant MFA, a full device inventory, encrypted traffic and smaller perimeters, applications treated as internet-connected, and data protection built on categorization. CISA's maturity model measures progress, and newer memos build on it.

Maturity stages (CISA ZTMM 2.0)

Traditional: manual, static, siloed. **Initial:** starting automation and cross-pillar integration. **Advanced:** automated, centralized, cross-pillar. **Optimal:** fully automated, dynamic, continuously optimized.

M-22-09 goals by pillar

CISA PILLAR	GOAL, IN SHORT	GO DEEPER
Identity	Enterprise-managed identities; phishing-resistant MFA	CISA ZTMM Identity
Devices	Complete device inventory; prevent, detect and respond on every device	CISA ZTMM Devices
Networks	Encrypt DNS and HTTP traffic; start breaking perimeters into isolated environments	CISA Microsegmentation Part One (Jul 2025)
Applications and Workloads	Treat every application as internet-connected; test rigorously; welcome external vulnerability reports	CISA ZTMM Applications
Data	A shared path to protections built on thorough data categorization	Federal ZT Data Security Guide (Oct 2024, rev. May 2025)
Visibility and Analytics (cross-cutting; not an M-22-09 pillar goal)	Logging and network visibility, now set by OMB M-26-14	OMB M-26-14 (May 2026)

Security idea or Zero Trust idea?

A Zero Trust idea is about a per-request access decision made on identity, device posture and context, enforced and logged, or about the inventory, tag or policy that feeds one.

"MFA is required" is a security idea. "All applications authenticate through the agency identity provider with phishing-resistant MFA, and you know which still hold their own accounts" is the Zero Trust version (Identity).

Sources

NIST SP 800-207 (csrc.nist.gov). EO 14028 (federalregister.gov). OMB M-22-09 and M-26-14 (whitehouse.gov). CISA ZTMM 2.0 and Microsegmentation Part One (cisa.gov). Federal Zero Trust Data Security Guide (resources.data.gov). Full links: kensden.github.io/zero-trust-field-guide/#sources

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TERM	MEANING
FCEB	Federal civilian executive branch: the agencies M-22-09 and CISA's guidance mostly address.
PE / PA / PEP	Policy engine decides, administrator issues, enforcement point allows or blocks each request. PDP = PE + PA.
Phishing-resistant MFA	MFA a fake login page cannot capture and replay, such as FIDO2 keys or PKI smart cards.
IdP / ICAM	Identity provider; Identity, Credential and Access Management program.
Microsegmentation	Dividing a network into small, controlled zones so a breach cannot easily move laterally.
Data categorization	Knowing what data you hold and how sensitive it is, so protections can use it.
SIEM / SOAR	Log correlation and alerting; automated response.

Dates

WHEN	WHAT
Aug 2020	NIST SP 800-207
May 2021	EO 14028
Jan 2022	OMB M-22-09
Apr 2023	CISA ZTMM 2.0
30 Sep 2024	End of FY2024, the M-22-09 deadline
Oct 2024	Federal Zero Trust Data Security Guide (revised May 2025)
Jul 2025	CISA Microsegmentation in Zero Trust, Part One
May 2026	OMB M-26-14, logging and network visibility